Appnable Blog Writing Guidelines

Purpose and how to use this guide

Every Appnable blog must follow these rules, whoever writes it. They keep our posts consistent, findable on search engines and credible to technical buyers in legal, financial services, pharmaceuticals and government.

Read the rules once, then use the pre-publish checklist on every draft. If a draft fails one item on the checklist, it is not ready to publish.

Pre-publish checklist

Tick every box before a blog goes live. Copy this list into each draft.

- ☐ 1,500 words or fewer (body + FAQs)
- ☐ Use the skill created on Claude to research high-ranking keyword (long-tail keywords or short-tail keyword) that is relevant to the blog.
- ☐ Choose one primary keyword from the researched keywords and ensure it's included in the title, URL, and the first 100 words
- ☐ Use the remaining researched keywords naturally in the body of the blog
- ☐ No keyword stuffing; a final read confirms the chosen keywords are included naturally and none were missed
- ☐ Title should be under 60 characters; meta description should be 140–160 characters
- ☐ Use UK English throughout, with Grammarly or other writing tools set to UK English
- ☐ Spelling, punctuation and terminology consistent throughout
- ☐ Reflects Appnable's brand voice and expertise, and the message is accurate and not misrepresented
- ☐ Every statistic, quote and data point is hyperlinked to its original source where it appears in the text (no reference list at the bottom)
- ☐ The blog should contain one internal links to Appnable "Solution" pages
- ☐ The blog should have two FAQs, each answer ending with a link to the website's FAQ page
- ☐ Include two or three "Read also" links to related Appnable blogs, once suitable articles are available (can be left out of the first one or two blogs)
- ☐ Include one clear call to action (book a demo, download a lead magnet, or contact us)
- ☐ Every image and is compressed and off High Definition
- ☐ Any technical claims in the blog should be checked by a subject-matter expert

- ☐ Proofread, and read aloud once for flow

1. Length and structure

A blog is 1,500 words maximum, and 1,000–1,500 words is the target range. The limit covers the body and the FAQs.

Every blog follows the same order:

1. **Title (H1)** – one per blog, containing the primary keyword.
2. **Introduction** – 80–120 words. State the problem and what the reader will learn. Use the primary keyword in the first 100 words.
3. **Body sections (H2s)** – three to five sections. Use H3s for sub-points under an H2; never skip a level.
4. **Conclusion** – 60–100 words, ending with the call to action.
5. **Read also** – two or three related blogs.
6. **FAQs** – at least two.
7. **Sources** – no reference list at the bottom; every source is hyperlinked where it is used in the text.

Keep paragraphs to three or four sentences and sentences under 25 words where you can. Use bullet points or a short table when you list steps, options or comparisons.

2. Keywords

Each blog targets one primary keyword and two to four supporting keywords, all tied to a service Appnable sells. These are the five keyword groups a buyer searching for our services is most likely to use. Use the skill created on Claude to research what high ranking keywords to use for a blog use and also to confirm the search volume of the keyword

Service area	Primary keyword	Supporting keywords
Microsoft 365 / Copilot	Microsoft Copilot consultant UK	Copilot readiness assessment, Copilot data security, Microsoft 365 consultancy
Automation	business process automation UK	workflow automation for regulated industries, Power Automate consultant, AI automation platform
Custom software	custom software development UK	bespoke business software, software development for financial services, legal tech development
ERP	ERP implementation UK	ERP consultancy, Dynamics 365 implementation, replacing spreadsheets with ERP
Compliance-led technology	technology consultancy for regulated industries	GDPR compliant software, data governance consultancy, digital transformation for law firms

Where the primary keyword must appear

- Title (H1), ideally near the start
- URL, for example `/blog/copilot-readiness-assessment`
- First 100 words

Rules

- Write for the reader first. If a keyword sounds forced, rephrase the sentence or drop it.
- Don't repeat the exact keyword more than four or five times in a 1,500-word post. Use natural variations instead.
- Never target the same primary keyword in two blogs; they will compete against each other in search. Log each blog's primary keyword in the content tracker.

3. Sources and references

Every statistic, quotation and data point needs a source the reader can check. No source, no claim.

- **Hyperlink in the text**: link each statistic, quote and data point to its original source, right where it is used. Example: "Over half of UK firms now use some form of AI, according to ONS data." Links open in a new tab.
- **No reference list**: don't add a References section at the bottom of the blog.
- **Check relevance**: confirm each linked source actually supports the claim it backs up.
- **Use credible sources**: official bodies (ONS, ICO, FCA, gov.uk), vendor documentation (Microsoft Learn), peer-reviewed research, established analysts (Gartner, McKinsey, Forrester) and reputable press.
- **Use recent data**: no statistic older than three years unless it's historical context; say the year in the sentence.
- **Go to the original**: if a blog quotes a statistic from another report, find and link that report instead.
- **Quote sparingly**: keep quotes short and in quotation marks, credited by name and role.
- **Avoid** competitor blogs, Wikipedia, AI-generated summaries and unsourced statistics as sources.

4. "Read also" links

Each blog links to two or three related Appnable blogs, so readers stay on the site and search engines understand how our content connects.

- **Choose by relevance**: same service area, the logical next step, or a deeper dive on a point the blog raises. A Copilot readiness blog could link to one on Copilot data security.
- **Place them in two spots**: one inline "Read also" link mid-blog, where it fits the point being made, and a "Read also" block of two or three links after the conclusion.

- **Link back**: when a new blog publishes, add a "Read also" link to it from one or two older related blogs.
- **Until we have enough blogs**: the "Read also" section can be left out of the first one or two blogs; add it once suitable articles are available.
- **Check quarterly** that every "Read also" link still works and is still the best match.

5. FAQs

Every blog ends with at least two FAQs, and each answer leads the reader to the website's FAQ page.

- **Pick real questions**: ones prospects ask on calls, in comments, or that appear in Google's "People also ask" box for the primary keyword.
- **Write the question as a reader would type it**, for example: "How long does a Copilot rollout take?"
- **Answer in 40–60 words**, directly in the first sentence, then end with a link: "See more on our [FAQ page](FAQ page URL)."
- **Keep it consistent**: the question should also exist on the FAQ page. If it doesn't, send it to the web admin to add.
- **Use a supporting keyword** in at least one question.

Note: Google now shows FAQ rich results mainly for government and health sites, so don't expect FAQ snippets in search. FAQs still answer reader questions, support search and AI answer engines, and push traffic to the FAQ page.

6. Additional standards

SEO basics

- **Title**: under 60 characters, primary keyword near the start, a clear benefit. Example: "Copilot Readiness: 5 Checks Before You Switch It On".
- **URL slug**: short, lowercase, hyphens, keyword only. No dates or stop words.
- **Internal links**: at least one link to a relevant Appnable Solution page, using descriptive anchor text.
- **Images**: one featured image plus visuals where they help. Write alt text that describes the image; compress files to under 200 KB.
- **Call to action**: one per blog, matched to the topic, such as booking a demo or downloading the Copilot data-safety check.

Technical accuracy

- Have an engineer or subject-matter expert review every technical claim, step and screenshot before publishing.
- Name product versions and dates where they matter ("as of October 2026"); software changes fast.
- Explain each acronym the first time it appears, for example "Enterprise Resource Planning (ERP)".

Writing style

- Write for a busy decision-maker: lead with the answer, then explain.
- Use plain UK English and active voice.
- No clichés, filler or AI-sounding copy. Cut phrases like "in today's fast-paced world" or "unlock the power of".
- Use specific examples from the industries we serve: legal, financial services, pharmaceuticals and government.
- Never name a client or share client data without written approval.

Review and upkeep

- Each blog gets two reviews before publishing: a technical review and a marketing review against this checklist.